



# St. Theodore Catholic Church

168 Spencerport Road ~ Rochester, NY 14606 ~ (585) 429-6811

Website: sttheodoreschurch.com

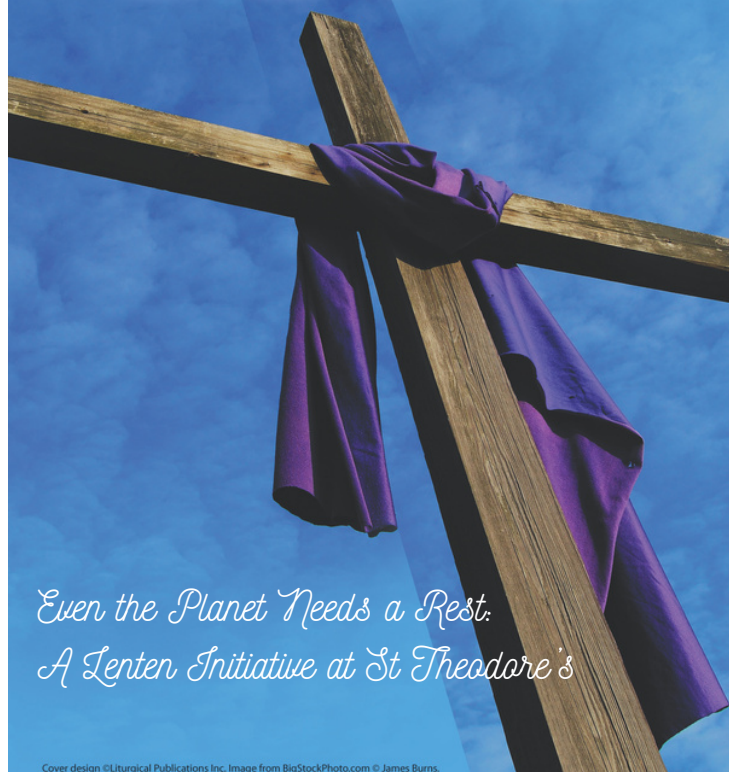
Email: gsttheod@dor.org

Facebook & Instagram Pages: St. Theodore's Catholic Church, Rochester, NY

*"Broken, we gather. Nourished, we are sent forth"*

March 8, 2026

## THIRD SUNDAY OF LENT



St. Theodore's Parish is a diverse community brought together by our faith in Jesus Christ. As a Roman Catholic community, we further our love and trust in God through worship, education, outreach and stewardship. We join with other communities in the Diocese of Rochester to spread the Good News. We celebrate the sacraments to worship God and nurture our faith. We welcome new members to journey with us to the fullness of life in the Kingdom.

### St. Theodore Parish Office

Temporarily located at Parish of the Holy Family Parish Office  
4100 Lyell Road, Rochester, NY 14606  
Monday-Friday: 9 am-3 pm  
(585) 429-6811

### Regular Mass Times

Saturday Vigil: 4:30 pm; Sunday: 9:00 & 11:00 am  
Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday: 8:30 am  
Thursday, Communion Service: 8:30 am  
Holy Days: 8:30 am & 5:30 pm

### Confession Times

Saturdays: 2:30-4:00 pm; or by appointment

### Week 3 Rest

Practice Sabbath: Make intentional space to rest today.

#### *The Peace of Wild Things*

-by Wendell Berry-

When despair for the world grows in me  
and I wake in the night at the least sound  
in fear of what my life and my children's lives may be,  
I go and lie down where the wood drake  
rests in his beauty on the water, and the great heron feeds.

I come into the peace of wild things  
who do not tax their lives with forethought  
of grief. I come into the presence of still water.  
And I feel above me the day-blind stars  
waiting with their light. For a time  
I rest in the grace of the world, and am free.

#### *Primary Wonder*

-by Denise Levertov-

Days pass when I forget the mystery.  
Problems insoluble and problems offering  
their own ignored solutions  
jostle for my attention, they crowd its antechamber  
along with a host of diversions, my courtiers, wearing  
their colored clothes; cap and bells.  
And then once more the quiet mystery  
is present to me, the throng's clamor recedes:  
the mystery that there is anything, anything at all,  
let alone cosmos, joy, memory, everything,  
rather than void: and that, O Lord,  
Creator, Hallowed One, You still,  
hour by hour sustain it.

Reflect: Each of these poets is writing about finding sacred moments in the everyday, finding hope or peace or "mystery" that sustains them. In challenging times, how or where, do you find your way to sacred moments like these?

"In our own contemporary context of the rat race of anxiety, the celebration of Sabbath is an act of both resistance and alternative. It is resistance because it is a visible insistence that our lives are not defined by the production and consumption of commodity goods."

WALTER BRUEGGEMANN, SABBATH AS RESISTANCE:  
SAYING NO TO THE CULTURE OF NOW



### Upcoming Novena to St. Joseph

My brothers and sisters,

As we approach the Solemnity of Saint Joseph (March 19th), our parish will gather for a Novena to Saint Joseph from Tuesday, March 10th through Wednesday, March 18th. We will gather each evening at 6:30 pm. The one exception to this will be Saturday, March 14th when the Novena will take place immediately after evening Mass. Each night will include a brief reflection (about five to eight minutes) on the Scripture passage and grace for that day before we enter into the novena prayers themselves.

Each day of the novena places Saint Joseph before us in a different moment of the Gospel: his place in the genealogy of Christ and his abandonment to Divine Providence; his chaste and reverent love in the betrothal to Mary; his obedience at the angel's word; his adoration of the newborn Savior; his acceptance of authority in naming Jesus; his fidelity in presenting the Child in the Temple; his fortitude in fleeing to Egypt; his persevering faith in the loss of the Child Jesus; and finally, his peaceful and happy death in the hands of God.

The prayers themselves ask Saint Joseph to show himself a father to us—to obtain for us grace, mercy, and courage, and to defend us from every evil. We will also entrust to his intercession the particular needs of our parish, especially our buildings and grounds concerns, asking for prudence, patience, and a stable financial footing so that our mission and ministries may be strengthened.

We will pray as well for Bishop Bonnici, that he may be a faithful and peaceful steward of the flock entrusted to him.

I encourage you to join us for as many evenings as you are able. In turning to Saint Joseph, we entrust our parish and our own lives to a strong and faithful guardian.

- Fr. Dave Tedesche

Check out all of Father Dave's homilies on his website at: [www.catholicpatrimony.com](http://www.catholicpatrimony.com)



Please pray for the souls who have recently passed away including:

**Joanne Baker, RoseMarie D'Agnolo,  
Gaetana Giallanza & Alfred Pannoni**

### Adult Altar Servers Needed



We are in need of a couple adult altar servers who can rotate serving for the 4:30 pm Mass. These servers will carry the cross in the procession & recession and assist Father on the altar. Training is provided. Please call Tom Rizzo at 314-8244 if you are interested in helping.

### Theo's Closet

Donations to Theo's Closet may be dropped off **at the west side entrance off Dunn Tower Drive at Door E/All Saints during hours of operation only, please.**

Theo's Closet has set up in the hallway of the north wing of the building, and is regularly open **Monday & Wednesday, 10 am-12 pm.** Please use the west side entrance off Dunn Tower Drive.



### Communications from the Parish Office

Please remember to browse the church bulletin boards, read the bulletin, check our website and watch for emails from the Parish Office for important communications. Thank you!

An email was sent to all Lectors and EMs on February 26 to sign up for the Spring Schedule (March 28-June 28).



If you did not receive it, please check your Junk and Trash folders first. If it is not in either one of those places, then call Pamela to have her resend it. It will come from [info@signupgenius.com](mailto:info@signupgenius.com) and must be in your email address book to come into your INBOX. Thank you!

| St. Theodore's CMA Goal is \$85,000 |             |
|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| Pledged as of 2/26/2026             | \$59,677.50 |
| % of our Goal                       | 70.21%      |
| Households participating            | 272         |
| Total Households in Parish          | 957         |

### Thank you to all those who have already pledged to the CMA Campaign!

If you have not made a pledge, please consider participating in the CMA campaign! It supports the ministries of our Bishop and our parish. Remember, half the amount over our goal comes back to the parish.

Pledge/donate any amount; what's important is your participation. You can mail your pledge to the Diocese or place the envelope into the Sunday offering and we will forward it for you. There are extra envelopes at the entrances to the church. Thank you to all who have already most generously contributed!



### Stations of the Cross

Every Friday during Lent,  
after the 8:30 am weekday Mass.

*Thank you to the good stewards who continue to support our  
parish through their time, talent and treasure...  
St. Theodore's is very blessed to have your support!*

#### FINANCES FOR THE WEEK OF FEBRUARY 28/MARCH 1

|                      |             |
|----------------------|-------------|
| Weekly Amount Needed | \$10,100.00 |
| Sunday Collection    | \$10,918.97 |
| Maintenance Fund     | \$1,122.00  |
| Attendance           | 642         |

### Food Cupboard

The idea for **40 Foods for 40 Days** is a simple one – each parishioner donates 1 food item, for each of the 40 days of lent, February 18 to March 29 (Palm Sunday).

The **40 Foods for 40 Days** works well when all parishioners commit to donating 40 items of food during Lent and its most certainly in keeping with the spirit of Lenten sacrifice.

This will certainly help our food cupboard in the critical fight against hunger in our area!

We are asking you to make a real sacrifice by donating our most needed items.

We hope everyone young and old will take up the practice of selfless giving to help those in need in our community.

Donations can be brought in each weekend and placed in the Food cupboard cart – you do not have to bring in all 40 items at the same time. NOTE: Please bring food that is fresh, not expired, and no dented cans.

All food must be brought in by **SUNDAY, March 29.**

Cut out this list and attach to your grocery list.....



#### For St. Theo's Food Cupboard

|                                                   |                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Canned Beef Stew                                  | Crackers               |
| Tuna                                              | Jell-O/Pudding Mix     |
| Tuna Helper                                       | Canned Fruit           |
| Spam                                              | Instant/Boxed Potatoes |
| 1 lb. canned Ham                                  | Pork & Beans           |
| Canned Chili                                      | Baked Beans            |
| Hamburger Helper                                  | Peanut Butter          |
| Corned Beef Hash                                  | Jelly/Jam              |
| Rice-A-Roni/Rice                                  | Pasta                  |
| Soup (any kind)                                   | Pasta Sauce            |
| Tea / Coffee                                      | Canned Pasta           |
| Pancake Mix & Syrup                               | Pasta Sides            |
| Canned Tomatoes (diced, stewed)                   |                        |
| Gravy (canned, jar, or Mix)                       |                        |
| Adult Cereal (Cheerios, Corn flakes, Raisin Bran) |                        |



**Our facilities are all-accessible.**

**Parish Office: (585) 429-6811**  
**Hours: Monday - Friday, 9 am - 3 pm**

#### Parish Staff

**Rev. David Tedesche, Pastor**—[fr.david.tedesche@dor.org](mailto:fr.david.tedesche@dor.org)  
**Dennis Lohouse, Deacon**—[dennis.lohouse@dor.org](mailto:dennis.lohouse@dor.org)  
**Laurence Feasel, Senior Deacon**—[laurence.feasel@dor.org](mailto:laurence.feasel@dor.org)  
**David Paluskiewicz, Senior Deacon**—  
[david.paluskiewicz@dor.org](mailto:david.paluskiewicz@dor.org)  
**Maureen Piehler, Director of Faith Formation & Youth Ministry**—[maureen.piehler@dor.org](mailto:maureen.piehler@dor.org)  
**Rita Manners, Music Director**—[rita.manners@dor.org](mailto:rita.manners@dor.org)  
**Pamela Gardner, Administrative Assistant**—  
[pamela.gardner@dor.org](mailto:pamela.gardner@dor.org)  
**Christopher Frontale, Finance Director**—  
[christopher.frontale@dor.org](mailto:christopher.frontale@dor.org)

**Baptisms**—Please call the Parish Office at (585) 429-6811 for information on scheduling a baptism. Please note: Baptisms are not done during Lent.

**Hospital Calls**—Please call the Parish Office to have a priest or pastoral staff member visit you while you are in the hospital. Due to privacy laws, we cannot access information about your hospitalization unless you indicate St. Theodore's as your faith community on your admissions forms!

**Sacrament of Reconciliation**—Saturdays from 2:30-4:00 pm or by appointment.

**Weddings**—Contact Deacon Dennis Lohouse at (585) 429-6811 or [dennis.lohouse@dor.org](mailto:dennis.lohouse@dor.org) as soon as possible to reserve the church before you sign a contract with a reception hall.

**Faith Formation for Children in Grades 1-9 including Sacrament Preparation**—Contact Maureen Piehler at (585) 429-5650 for program information. For 2025-26, classes will be held at Parish of the Holy Family, Parish Life Center, 4100 Lyell Road.

**Youth Ministry for Grades 6-12**—Contact Maureen Piehler for information at (585) 429-5650.

#### SUNDAY OFFERING ENVELOPES

Please continue to mail in your envelopes on a weekly basis. We are also accepting envelopes in the Parish Office during Parish Office hours. Your financial support is greatly appreciated and needed at this time.

Please remember St. Theodore's Church of Gates, NY in your will.

Please also consider memorial donations to be sent to our parish upon a loved one's death.

**Our Eucharistic Chapel is open 6am - 8pm all year round for prayer and reflection.**

**Saturday, March 7 - Sts. Perpetua & Felicity**

4:30 pm For the people of St. Theodore's Parish

**Sunday, March 8 - 3<sup>rd</sup> Sunday of Lent**

9:00 am Deborah Plaice - St. Theodore's Choir

John Rivoli - Family

11:00 am Rosa Verde - Tony &amp; Mickey Ruggiero

**Monday, March 9 - St. Frances of Rome**

8:30 am Victor Stanco - Anne, Carmen &amp; Patty Butch &amp; Family

**Tuesday, March 10**

8:30 am For the Intentions of Lorrie Leone - Morning Mass Group

**Wednesday, March 11**

8:30 am Michael A. DelCorvo - Wife &amp; Family

**Thursday, March 12**

8:30 am Communion Service

**Friday, March 13**

8:30 am For the Intentions of Ariana, Addison &amp; Camden - Sarah Reger

**Saturday, March 14**

4:30 pm Don Pelino - John &amp; Mary Taddeo

Marlene Carpino - Luigi &amp; Rosemarie LaPietra

**Sunday, March 15 - 4<sup>th</sup> Sunday of Lent**

9:00 am Rosa Verde - Tony &amp; Mickey Ruggiero

Maria Tata - Sister, Rosaria Sorce &amp; Family

11:00 am For the people of St. Theodore's Parish

***This Week at Our Parish*****Sunday, March 8 - Daylight Saving Time Begins**

9:00 am OCIA/OCIC - Gym

10:00 am Bible Study - Gym

10:00 am Grades 10-12 Confirmation Class - Church, 100<sup>th</sup> Ann. Corner

10:15 am 1st Communion Class - Gym

11:00am-4:30pm Year Two Confirmation Retreat - Church &amp; Gym

**Monday, March 9**

5:00 pm Faith Formation (Grades 1-5) - HF PLC

7:00 pm Faith Formation (Grades 6-9) - HF PLC

**Tuesday, March 10**

1:00 pm Bell Choir - Church

6:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

6:30 pm Parish Council Meeting - Church for Novena, then meeting

**Wednesday, March 11**

6:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

7:00 pm Choir Rehearsal - Church

**Thursday, March 12**

6:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

7:00 pm Fellowship Committee - Gym

**Friday, March 13**

6:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

**Saturday, March 14**

5:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

**Sunday, March 15**

9:00 am OCIA/OCIC - Gym

10:00 am Bible Study - Gym

10:00 am Grades 10-12 Confirmation Class - Church, 100<sup>th</sup> Ann. Corner

10:15 am 1st Communion Class - Gym

11:00am-4:30pm Year Two Confirmation Retreat - Church/Gym

6:30 pm St. Joseph Novena - Church

**Novena to St. Joseph Begins This Week**

Father Dave will lead a Novena to St. Joseph for nine (9) days **beginning THIS Tuesday, March 10** and every day **until Wednesday, March 18**. The intention



will be for the successful resolution of our buildings & grounds concerns. Father Dave invites ALL parishioners to come to church at **6:30 pm each evening** (except Saturday's will start at 5:30 pm, right after the 4:30 pm Mass). Please come to pray with him for our parish!

**St. Theodore's Fellowship**

The Fellowship Committee is having a meeting **THIS Thursday, March 12<sup>th</sup>** at 7:00 pm/after the Novena in the gym. Anyone who is interested in helping us brainstorm ideas for future events and help out at those events are welcome to attend!

**Another Fun Bingo Night!**

The Fellowship Committee is having a Pizza and Bingo night in the gym on Saturday, March 21st after the 4:30pm Mass. Doors open at 5:15pm. Let's get together for an evening of fun and games! Please call the Parish office at 429-6811 by Wednesday, March 19 to reserve your spot! This helps for planning the amount of pizza we order.

**Anna's Angels  
Prom/Formal Dress Giveaway Event****Saturday, March 21****11:00 am - 3:00 pm****St. Theo's Gym**

We will have a variety of gently used dresses in a variety of colors, styles and sizes.

Stop by and pick out a FREE dress for your special occasion!

IN LOVING MEMORY OF ANNAMARIA

*Spread the word!***SAVE-THE-DATE****Monday-Friday,  
July 20-24**

Before you start signing your children up for summer camps, be sure to mark your calendar for a fun-filled week at St. Theodore's Vacation Bible School!

*More information will be coming soon.*



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